A Wife’s Brain Versus Her Husband’s Brain

Transcript prepared for Union

***Note:** In this video, a **wife** is speaking. She compares how her own brain works with how her **husband’s** brain works, in five areas. Everywhere you see “I,” “me,” or “my,” it is the wife speaking; “he” and “him” are her husband.*

1. Sex

Wife: Sex is how my husband feels close to me. I need to feel close before I want sex.

Husband: He reaches for my body to check if we’re okay.

Wife: I need us to feel okay before I give him my body.

That’s not a game. That is two bonding systems working synergistically together. He uses sex to connect. I use connection to want sex.

2. What we need most

Husband: Respect. If I talk down to him, roll my eyes, or make him feel small, he shuts down. (I don’t do this, by the way.)

Wife: Emotional safety. If I feel neglected, I go cold.

He can survive stress, but he cannot survive feeling disrespected by his woman. I can survive a hard day, but I cannot survive feeling invisible next to him.

3. Stress

Husband: He goes quiet. He needs silence to think and process.

Wife: I need to talk it out. That’s how I release it.

Us women move toward connection under stress. Men move toward space.

4. Problems

Husband: “Tell me what’s wrong so I can fix it.”

Wife: “Don’t fix it yet. Hear me first.”

He’s built to find the solution. That’s how he shows love. I’m built to feel understood before the solution means anything. That’s how I feel loved.

5. Love

Husband: He shows it by doing — money, security, protection, safety.

Wife: I feel it when he’s here — his look, his touch, his presence.

My husband can provide all day and I still feel unloved. I can talk all night and he still feels useless. He’s speaking action. I’m speaking attention.

If we don’t translate any of this into language our brains understand, we both feel like we’re giving everything and getting nothing.

Her closing: Learn each other’s brains and you will live a happier life. I promise you.